

Employee Handbook

Code of Conduct

All employees are expected to act with integrity, treat colleagues and customers with respect, and avoid conflicts of interest. Employees must not accept gifts worth more than INR 2,000 from vendors or clients without disclosing them to their manager. Harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind will result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

Any employee who becomes aware of a potential conflict of interest -- for example a family member employed by a supplier or competitor -- must declare it to HR in writing within 14 days of becoming aware of it.

Raising a Concern

Concerns about misconduct can be raised with the reporting manager, with HR, or anonymously through the confidential ethics hotline. All reports are investigated by HR within 10 working days. The company prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith, whether or not the concern is ultimately substantiated.

Working Hours

Standard working hours are 9:30 AM to 6:30 PM, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour lunch break. Northwind Retail Corp. operates a flexible working policy allowing employees to shift their start time between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM, provided core hours (11:00 AM to 4:00 PM) are respected.

Employees are not expected to respond to work communications outside their working hours except when on a formally rostered on-call rotation.

Benefits Overview

Full-time employees are eligible for group health insurance covering the employee, spouse, and up to two dependent children, effective from the first day of employment. The company also provides a wellness allowance of INR 15,000 per year, reimbursable against gym memberships, fitness classes, or mental health counselling.

Additional benefits include group term life insurance at three times annual base salary, an annual preventive health check-up, and an employee assistance programme offering confidential counselling sessions at no cost to the employee.

Learning and Development

Each employee has an annual learning budget of INR 40,000 that may be spent on courses, certifications, conferences, or books relevant to their role. Requests are approved by the reporting manager and reimbursed through the expense management system against itemized receipts.

Certification exam fees are reimbursed only on a passing result.

Probation and Confirmation

New employees serve a probation period of 3 months from their date of joining. Performance is reviewed by the reporting manager at the end of the probation period, and confirmation of employment is communicated in writing by HR within 2 weeks of the review.

Probation may be extended once, by a maximum of 3 additional months, where the reporting manager documents specific performance concerns and an improvement plan.

Notice Period and Exit

Confirmed employees are required to serve a notice period of 60 days on resignation; employees still on probation serve 15 days. The company may waive part of the notice period at its discretion. Exit formalities include return of all company IT assets, an exit interview with HR, and final settlement within 45 days of the last working day.